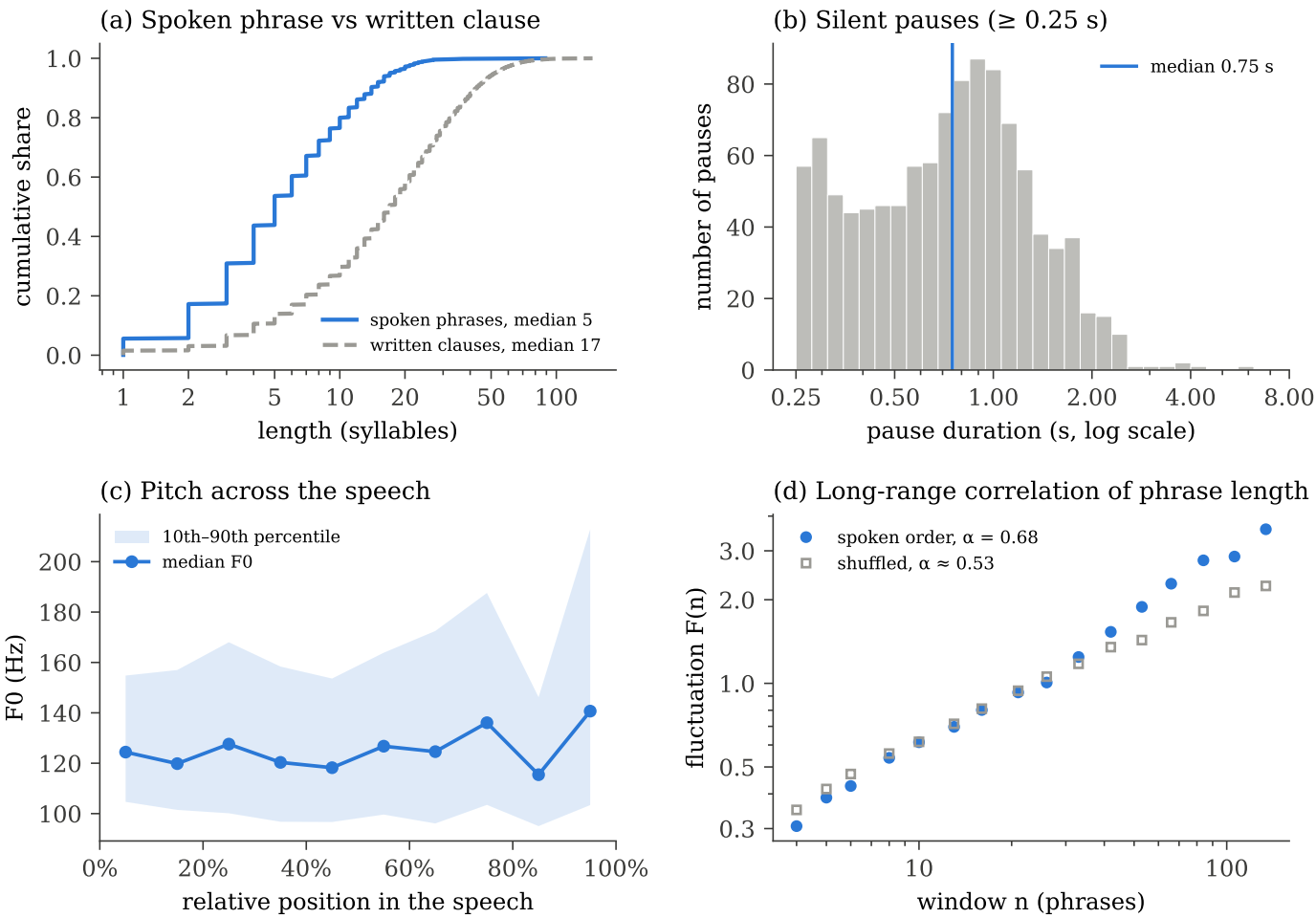
(a) Spoken phrase vs written clause
cumulative share
1.0
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0
spoken phrases, median 5
written clauses, median 17
1
2
5
10
20
50
100
length (syllables)
(b) Silent pauses (≥ 0.25 s)
number of pauses
80
60
40
20
0
median 0.75 s
0.25
0.50
1.00
2.00
4.00
8.00
pause duration (s, log scale)
(c) Pitch across the speech
F0 (Hz)
200
180
160
140
120
100
10th–90th percentile
median F0
0%
20%
40%
60%
80%
100%
relative position in the speech
(d) Long-range correlation of phrase length
fluctuation F(n)
3.0
2.0
1.0
0.5
0.3
spoken order, α = 0.68
shuffled, α ≈ 0.53
10
100
window n (phrases)